IELTS ACADEMIC · RESTRICTED STAFF MATERIAL

IELTS Academic Set 22

PRIVATE STAFF answer key and Listening transcript

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Answer keys and Listening transcripts are restricted to staff.

Listening

Question	Answer	Accepted variants
1	Northbank	north bank
2	raised bed	
3	Tuesday	
4	12 months	1 year, one year, twelve months
5	wheelbarrow	
6	14 May	14th may, may 14, may 14th, may fourteenth, 14/5, 14/05, 14-5, 14-05
7	main gate	
8	photo ID	photo identification, photographic id, photographic identification
9	gardening gloves	garden gloves, gloves
10	volunteer team	volunteer, volunteers
11	B	
12	B	
13	A	
14	A	
15	A	
16	B	
17	C	
18	E	

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Question	Answer	Accepted variants
19	G	
20	H	
21	A	
22	C	
23	B	
24	B	
25	A	
26	C	
27	B	
28	A	
29	C	
30	B	
31	residue	
32	hyphae	
33	network	
34	drying	
35	coating	layer
36	selected	
37	shredded	
38	pH	
39	moulds	molds
40	water absorption	absorption, uptake

Listening transcript

Part 1 - everyday social dialogue

EUAN	Good morning, Northbank Community Allotments. Euan speaking. How can I help?
ISLA	Hello. My name is Isla MacLeod. I moved to the west end recently, and I'd like to put my name down for a plot. I saw two sites on the council page, but I wasn't sure which one currently accepts applications.
EUAN	Both accept names for their waiting lists. Riverside is larger and has conventional plots, while Northbank has several smaller spaces and raised beds. Which location would suit you?

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ISLA	I first thought Riverside because it's near the bus route. Actually, after checking the walking distance from my flat, Northbank is closer, so please put Northbank as my preferred site.
EUAN	Certainly. The smaller plots there are popular with new growers. Would you like a standard ground plot, or one of the raised beds? A raised bed is easier to manage, though it has less growing space.
ISLA	The raised bed, please. I work full time, so a smaller area is sensible for my first season. I can always apply for a standard plot later if I manage it well.
EUAN	We ask members to name one day when they will usually visit. It doesn't stop you coming on other days; it simply helps us plan volunteer cover. At present we have cover on Tuesday, Thursday and Saturday.
ISLA	Saturday sounds convenient, but that's when I often visit my parents. Tuesday is much more reliable because I finish work early, so enter Tuesday as my regular day.
EUAN	Good. Membership isn't a casual weekly arrangement. New members make a minimum commitment, then renew if they want to continue. The fee is collected every six months, but the commitment itself is longer.
EUAN	The minimum membership period is twelve months. That gives people enough time to prepare the bed, plant it and complete a full growing cycle.
ISLA	That's fine. I own small hand tools, but I don't have room at home for anything bulky. Does the communal shed have equipment members can borrow?
EUAN	Yes. Spades, forks and watering cans are stored there. We have two wheelbarrows as well, but because they're in demand I need to mark one large item on your form. Shall I record a wheelbarrow?
ISLA	Yes, a wheelbarrow would be the useful one. I can bring my own fork and trowel. What happens before I get the gate code?
EUAN	You attend a short induction. The next one was advertised for the seventh of May, but that session filled yesterday. We've added another on the fourteenth of May, and I can reserve you a place then.
ISLA	The fourteenth works. Is the induction held in the tool shed? I noticed a small classroom on the site map as well.
EUAN	The classroom is used once the tour starts, and the shed comes later when we explain tool returns. Don't go to either place first, because the gate may still be locked.
EUAN	Meet me at the main gate. I'll check the attendance list there and take the group inside together.
ISLA	Right. Should I bring the confirmation email, or is the reference number enough?
EUAN	Neither is necessary because your name will be on my list. Please bring photo ID, though. We must confirm the person receiving the gate code is the applicant.
ISLA	No problem. I was planning to wear old shoes. Do I need to buy safety glasses or heavy boots before the session?
EUAN	Closed shoes are enough for the induction, and safety glasses aren't needed for the basic tour. We provide gardening gloves, so don't buy those specially. Just choose a pair when you arrive.

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ISLA	Thanks. If my train is delayed that morning, should I call this office number?
EUAN	The office is closed on induction mornings. Email the volunteer team instead; one of them monitors that inbox from half past eight and can tell you whether the group has entered the site.
ISLA	Great. I have everything I need for the application and the induction. That all sounds manageable.
EUAN	Excellent. I'll send the application link this morning. If anything is unclear, just reply to that message.

Part 2 - everyday social monologue

NINA	Kia ora, everyone, and welcome to Rimu Downs Sky Night. I'm Nina Harwood, the event leader. We are using a working grass airstrip south of Christchurch, arranged tonight as a one-way observing route. Keep to the marked path and ask a steward before crossing the strip. Although aircraft operations ended this afternoon, uneven ground and darkness still require care.
NINA	A narrow bank of cloud is forecast around opening time, though the clearer air behind it should arrive soon. If the cloud is still over us at half past seven, we will not cancel or send groups straight to the northern stations. The instruments will stay covered while I spend longer beside the trailer on the safety welcome and a planisphere demonstration. We will release the first rotation only when a useful gap appears.
NINA	At check-in, each small group receives a numbered wooden disc. Suppose yours is three: carry it along the early route, and when three appears on the telescope board, take it to the circle. At the end of that timed turn, place it in the steward's return tray so the next group can be called. The untimed binocular stop is the exception; carry the disc through there.
NINA	Switch ordinary white torches off before leaving the trailer. A bright beam can undo the adjustment your eyes have made and affect people nearby. A deep red filter gives enough light for the arrows while preserving far more of that dark adaptation. Keep phone screens dimmed and inside a red sleeve unless a steward requests one in an emergency.
NINA	Most instruments stand on grass, which is soft after rain. One visitor tonight uses a mobility aid and cannot safely reach those tripods. Staff will therefore relocate our smallest portable telescope after the gate closes, when vehicle movements have ended and stray light can be screened. A steward will also bring a suitable seat and keep the approach clear. Together, these changes create a stable observing station without adding another lit path.
NINA	Now follow the map from the south-east arrival lane. The central rectangle is the north-south airstrip. The hedge is west, the open eastern horizon opposite, and the wind sock beyond the northern end. The route runs clockwise and returns down the east edge. Do not cross the central grass.
NINA	Before joining the dark path, collect any borrowed seat, blanket or star wheel from the table immediately beside the check-in trailer. Damaged equipment is exchanged there; the desk inside handles names only. Then walk towards the south-east corner of the route.
NINA	At the threshold where the route leaves the arrival side, a steward will inspect torch filters and cover any remaining white LEDs. This checkpoint is before the path bends west, not on the paved return strip. Continue across the bottom of the airstrip until you reach the gap in the western hedge.

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NINA	Just through that south-west gap, low tripod mounts carry the wide-view binoculars. They face the broad southern sky and sit close to the hedge for shelter. Farther north, a recess holds spare folded tripods; that position is marked on the plan but has no activity for visitors tonight, so keep walking past it.
NINA	The path then reaches a round clearing in the north-west corner. The larger telescopes form an arc there, leaving the centre open for people to change places safely. It may look quicker to approach them from the airstrip, but all groups must enter from the western path and leave across the top.
NINA	Across the northern end you will see a ground marker for the meteor count. It is near the wind sock but deliberately several paces south of it, so observers can look upward without standing beneath the mast. The spur on the north-east side is reserved for a later horizon talk and is not part of the count.
NINA	Finally, turn down the eastern return edge. The level viewing patch is at the southern end of that edge, beside the arrival lane and opposite the trailer. Shielding will be ready before the portable instrument arrives. After finishing, continue directly to check-out rather than circling again.
NINA	Stay with your group, keep voices low near instruments, and report any loose cable or unstable surface to the nearest steward. Warm drinks remain at check-out after the route.

Part 3 - educational/training discussion

NORA	We have three hours for tomorrow's production practical. Our pair must present seeded loaves, enriched breakfast buns and fruit pastries, but the other pair has booked some of the same equipment. If we follow the recipe folder from top to bottom, we will probably be waiting at the worst possible moments.
CALEB	Before we build the timetable, let's divide the routine jobs. Last week I tried to prepare two flour batches at once and my totals drifted. You were much steadier at that bench.
NORA	I'll take the scales, then. I can prepare every set of dry ingredients and seal each one in a labelled container before the first mixer is free.
CALEB	That leaves the allergen sheet. I can read the codes aloud while you compare them with the containers, although I don't want one person's glance to count as the final check.
NORA	Agreed. We each need to verify every line and add our initials. If either signature is missing, the assessor will send the batch back before production starts.
NORA	I can set the proofer when we arrive, but during shaping I'll be facing away from its display. The narrow timing windows worry me more than the initial temperature setting.
CALEB	I'll stay responsible for that cabinet once the trays enter it. I can note each time and give you a warning before a check is due, even while the pastry cases are resting.
NORA	The same timing sheet should guide the oven. If two people keep opening its door to add separate trays, the temperature will fall and the sequence will become harder to recover.
CALEB	Since I'll have those times in front of me, I'll handle the loading as well. You can remain at the bench and finish the next shaping task without crossing the room.
CALEB	We still need the cooling log. I could note the readings between washing the bowl and cleaning the mixer, but that would split my attention just when the first rack comes out.

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NORA	Leave the temperature record with me. It fits the traceability paperwork I'm already keeping, and you won't have to stop cleaning whenever a product reaches the next check point.
CALEB	Now for the sequence. I first put the fruit pastries at the top because the cases need chilling. But assembly is quick, and that plan pushes the bulkiest dough much too late.
NORA	The bun dough is not entirely forgiving either, though it can spend part of its first rise on the warm bench. The seeded batch is different: its schedule allows almost twice as long before it is ready to bake.
CALEB	Then the seeded batch has to go through the mixer before the others. Its pre-weighed flour saves a few minutes, but that convenience would not matter if the rise were as short as the buns'.
NORA	Once those first trays are put away to rise, we gain a useful block. The bun glaze would fill only a few minutes of it, whereas the cooked fruit needs time to lose its heat before it can touch the pastry.
CALEB	So that gap is when we should prepare the filling. Doing it at the very beginning would interrupt the dough setup, and leaving it until the baking is nearly over would make packing impossible.
NORA	Let's test that timetable against the equipment. The scales were recalibrated yesterday. The proofer looks small, but six trays fit if we stagger the shelves, which covers our peak demand.
CALEB	The queue forms farther along. Our pair has a single oven, and the three products require separate settings. Even if several trays finish rising together, they cannot all move on at once.
NORA	We might recover time while portioning the enriched dough. What if I judge the pieces by sight and check only the first one? Repeated weighing will cool the dough a little.
CALEB	The yeast would survive that, but the portions would vary in weight. The small ones would colour before the large ones had cooked through, and the display would look inconsistent.
NORA	Fair point. If the clock becomes tight, we can make fewer pastries and still demonstrate every required technique. I would rather not empty the whole container simply to avoid leftover filling.
CALEB	The marking sheet supports that choice. It rewards consistent colour and crumb across a batch; it does not award extra credit for filling every shelf or using the maximum quantity available.
NORA	We'll protect that consistency, then. One tray rotation should correct the hot side, and we can reduce the output rather than crowding the oven and getting mixed results.
CALEB	I'll draft the timeline tonight with equipment settings and target times. Could you add the ingredient quantities and mark where each inspection has to happen?
NORA	Yes. I'll use separate colours for the three product lines so clashes are visible. Let's also meet ten minutes early in case the other pair has altered the shared-equipment booking.

Part 4 - academic monologue

LECTURER	Today we will examine protective packaging in which a fungus helps convert low-value plant matter into a shaped composite. I will begin with the material's structure, move to a simplified laboratory workflow, and finish with one storage limitation. A classroom sequence can clarify relationships without claiming that every factory follows an identical recipe.

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LECTURER	The starting mixture is usually described as a substrate. Rather than using a solid sheet of finished paper, producers may begin with husks, stalk fragments or similar material left after crops are harvested or processed. In materials research, these secondary agricultural streams are commonly grouped under the term residue. They provide both physical bulk and nutrients, although their exact composition depends on the original crop and on what happened during processing.
LECTURER	The fungus is easy to misunderstand because a mushroom is the part most people recognise. Inside this composite, however, the active structure is made of microscopic filaments. One individual filament is a hypha; in the plural, those fine fungal threads are called hyphae. The distinction matters because hyphae are fungal structures, not plant fibres in the substrate. Together, many hyphae form the mycelium that grows through the material.
LECTURER	As the filaments extend, they branch around neighbouring particles and cross one another. Separate pieces that could once be poured begin to behave as one body. We can describe the connected arrangement as a binding network. The comparison with glue is only partial: a conventional adhesive is normally introduced as a liquid between surfaces, while here the connections develop as the organism spreads through the available spaces.
LECTURER	That growth must be brought to an end once the component has filled the intended form. Otherwise its dimensions and surface could continue to change during storage. The research review reports that controlled drying is commonly used to stop fungal growth on the substrate. This also lowers available water, but the effects should not be reversed: the evidence does not establish that only a separate high-temperature stage can end growth.
LECTURER	A bare composite may cushion an object well while remaining vulnerable to liquid at its outer surface. Designers can respond by applying a thin coating. Such a layer may reduce uptake during brief contact, but it does not make every design waterproof, and its chemistry may alter end-of-life options. The improvement must therefore be evaluated alongside disposal requirements rather than treated as an automatic environmental benefit.
LECTURER	We can now arrange a hypothetical teaching sequence. It is not attributed to the research review and is not a universal industrial standard. It shows how preparation affects later growth. Changes before incubation can alter how evenly the organism moves through the mixture and how faithfully the material fills a shape. It begins with incoming material and follows changes in particle size, incubation conditions and shape, connecting each preparation choice with a later physical effect.
LECTURER	First consider substrate selection. The review notes that agricultural wastes differ by type and are selected according to availability and suitability. For this teaching comparison, the incoming plant matter is therefore selected before further preparation; obviously unsuitable foreign pieces are excluded. Washing may remove surface dirt, but it does not decide which plant fraction enters the trial.
LECTURER	The retained pieces then pass through a cutting mill and are shredded to make their size more consistent. They should not become fine powder, since densely packed dust would leave little air space. Controlled variation is the aim: fragments should mix evenly yet remain open enough for gases to move through the bed.
LECTURER	Next comes incubation, when the fungus spreads through the prepared substrate. The review identifies pH as one condition that can affect both mycelial growth and colonisation. In a teaching comparison, technicians would therefore record this condition at regular intervals before the developing material moves to the shaping stage; particle size has already been set.

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LECTURER	After a fungal culture has been introduced and has begun to establish, the developing mixture must acquire the geometry of the package. It is placed into moulds that define corners, trays or protective blocks. A flat rack could support a piece later, but it would not impose the required three-dimensional form. At this stage the container is therefore also a shaping tool.
LECTURER	After the shaped samples have been dried, the final stage is performance testing. One measurement is water absorption: researchers record how much liquid the composite takes up under a stated test condition. The review reports substantial variation between composites and identifies high uptake as an important limitation. This measure concerns direct contact with water; it does not justify a claim that ordinary changes in ambient humidity make a stored component expand or contract.
LECTURER	The example therefore moves from selecting a usable plant fraction, through particle preparation and controlled incubation, to shaping, colonisation, stabilisation and performance testing. Each transition represents a design choice rather than proof that one recipe suits every fungal strain or crop stream. A route that works for a short, sheltered delivery may be unsuitable for repeated handling or long storage. Comparing several routes is more useful than treating the sequence as a fixed prescription for every crop input and production scale in practice.
LECTURER	For your seminar, compare the whole material system. Consider the origin of the plant input, the energy used during processing, any added surface treatment, the transport environment and the failure that the package must prevent. A biological ingredient can create useful opportunities, but it does not by itself establish low impact, safe disposal or reliable performance in every application.

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Reading

Question	Answer	Accepted variants
1	C	
2	A	
3	F	
4	D	
5	G	
6	B	
7	E	
8	increment borer	
9	controlled conditions	
10	reference materials	
11	cross-dating	
12	cracks	
13	metadata	
14	local knowledge	
15	repeated observation	
16	neutral	
17	spectral data	
18	visual reminders	
19	physiological measures	
20	walking routes	
21	TRUE	
22	FALSE	
23	NOT GIVEN	
24	TRUE	
25	FALSE	
26	NOT GIVEN	
27	E	
28	A	

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Question	Answer	Accepted variants
29	G	
30	B	
31	F	
32	I	
33	D	
34	YES	
35	NO	
36	NOT GIVEN	
37	YES	
38	NO	
39	YES	
40	NOT GIVEN	

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